

Sawyer Out As Pilot Of Phillies

PHILADELPHIA (UPD) — Eddie Sawyer, whose 1950 "Whiz Kids" were the Philadelphia Phils' only pennant-winners in the past 45 years, quit suddenly Thursday as manager of this year's Phillies and was replaced by young, aggressive Gene Mauch.

Mauch, a former major league infielder who skippered Minneapolis into the Little World Series two straight years, announced immediately in Homestead, Fla., he hopes to become "the best big league manager in the business."

All that the balding, 49-year-old Sawyer wants is out. The one-time professor reached his decision to quit Wednesday night and the only explanation he would make Thursday was, "I just don't want to manage a major league ball club."

Mauch could not arrive here in time for Thursday night's game against Milwaukee, and the club was guided in his absence by Coach Andy Cohen.

Thus ended, with "surprise and shock" on the part of club officials, the Phillies' second era under Sawyer. His first term as manager (1948-52) was highlighted by the '50 pennant, the Phils' first since 1915. His second term, which began July 22, 1958, was dismal—two last place finishes.

Most experts tab the Phils to finish last again this year, but Sawyer didn't criticize the players in his resignation.

And he insisted that spring training problems — which included a stormy incident when pitcher Jim Owens was fined \$600 for becoming involved in a tap-room scrape—were not a factor in his decision. He also insisted he had no trouble with the front office.

"I just don't care to manage a major league ball club," he repeated over and over to questioners. "I would like to stay in baseball, but have no plans at this time."